

Chapter 86-2

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When Liang Shi returned to the private room, she once again played the role of an invisible person.

Tonight's main characters were Xu Qingzhu and Su Yao.

Xu Qingzhu didn't talk much, exchanging more glances with Su Yao than words. The atmosphere in the private room was warm and harmonious.

Su Meiqi occasionally came over to chat with her, but it was just small talk.

Sheng Yu came over and asked her, "What should I call you from now on?"

"Call me sister too." Liang Shi picked her up and fed her a sweet kernel of corn. "You'll have three sisters from now on. Are you happy?"

Sheng Yu frowned, thinking seriously. "But you're Zhou Caihong's mom's colleague. Shouldn't I call you auntie?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"But I'm your sister's wife," Liang Shi said. "So I'm of the same generation as your sister."

"Then what does Zhou Caihong call you?" Sheng Yu started comparing.

Liang Shi answered, "She calls me Sister Liang."

"But Liang Wenxuan from Class 3 calls you auntie¹," Sheng Yu said. "We're clearly the same age. Zhou Caihong is such an idiot!"

Liang Shi's mind went blank for a second—who was Liang Wenxuan?

Then she remembered it was Ling Dang's formal name.

Other children outside always used formal names, but Liang Shi had never known Ling Dang's formal name.

Liang Shi was amused by Sheng Yu's childish words, but she still answered her seriously. "You two are the same age, but you're of different generations. In the Liang family, I'm Liang Wenxuan's aunt, but to you, I'm your sister. Rainbow didn't call me wrong—she's just smarter."

"No." Sheng Yu bared her teeth at her. "Zhou Caihong is an idiot!"

"Why? Do you two have some grudge?" Liang Shi asked.

Sheng Yu nodded, then shook her head, then said huffily, "Last week she didn't do her craft homework, so she stepped on mine and ruined it."

"Huh?" Liang Shi was shocked. "Really or not?"

Sheng Yu nodded, seemingly displeased with her doubt. "Of course it's real! I never lie!"

Liang Shi felt there must be some misunderstanding, so she stroked Sheng Yu's head and coaxed her gently. "Did she step on your craft homework on purpose?"

Sheng Yu shook her head. "No, she apologized to me."

Liang Shi finally relaxed. "Then did you forgive her?"

"I told her I'd forgive her if she made me an identical one," Sheng Yu said proudly. "That one was made by my mom with her own hands. She couldn't possibly make it."

Liang Shi: "..."

"And then?" Liang Shi asked.

Sheng Yu huffed lightly. "Of course she couldn't make it, so that's why I said she's an idiot!"

Liang Shi felt helpless. "Mom is good at these things, so she made you a beautiful craft project. But Rainbow hasn't learned how to do it, so it's normal that she can't. Besides, Rainbow is only five years old, just like you. Isn't it a bit unfair to ask this of her?"

"Of course." Liang Shi immediately added, "I'm not saying your request is wrong. After all, she did ruin your craft homework, and it's perfectly reasonable for you to ask her to compensate you with an identical one. But you can't mock her just because she can't make it, right?"

Sheng Yu tilted her head and looked at her with wide, expectant eyes. "Whose side are you on anyway?"

Liang Shi: "...I'm on the side of reason."

"Then I won't let my sister be with you anymore." Sheng Yu huffed. "Hmph! You're just siding with Zhou Caihong."

She was about to jump down from Liang Shi's arms, but Liang Shi held her tight and lightly flicked her forehead with a curved finger. "I'm clearly siding with you."

Sheng Yu: "?"

She snorted coldly. "You're lying!"

Liang Shi rocked her in her arms. "Rainbow is the top student in your school. She could recite five hundred ancient poems at three years old and is already doing middle school physics problems now. The only thing she can't do is craft homework, and that's because she lost to a mom who's good at these things—yet you call her an idiot."

Sheng Yu frowned. "But she just couldn't make it."

"You couldn't make it either," Liang Shi said. "If you could, would you need your mom to do your craft homework?"

Sheng Yu: "..."

"If even Rainbow is an idiot, what does that make you?" Liang Shi teased her. "A little genius?"

Sheng Yu was completely confused by her logic. She covered her ears and said, "I'm not listening, I'm not listening. Anyway, I don't want my sister to be with you anymore."

Liang Shi felt helpless. "Your sister won't listen to you."

Sheng Yu glared at her. "She definitely will!"

After saying that, she jumped down from Liang Shi's arms and toddled over to find Xu Qingzhu on her short little legs.

Sheng Yu walked over and tugged at Xu Qingzhu's arm. Xu Qingzhu was chatting with Su Yao about the Sheng family's recent situation.

When Sheng Linlang was mentioned, Su Yao was also full of nostalgia, saying she hadn't seen her in a long time. They used to be very close, but she always forgot why she had lost her memory.

Su Yao also said that she herself was too fragile and couldn't get through those painful days, which led to Xu Qingzhu being raised by Sheng Linlang all along.

It was thanks to Sheng Linlang's care that Xu Qingzhu had grown up so well.

Hearing these words, Xu Qingzhu felt awful inside, but she only comforted Su Yao. "You've already been very strong. You're really amazing."

Just as she finished speaking, Sheng Yu tugged at Xu Qingzhu's arm and looked up at her with those grape-purple eyes.

Xu Qingzhu asked, "What's wrong?"

Sheng Yu hugged her arm and acted coquettishly, wanting to be held. Xu Qingzhu picked her up. "What do you want?"

Back then, she and Xu Qingya weren't far apart in age, and Xu Qingya had a lively personality. After experiencing the kidnapping incident, Xu Qingzhu had become very withdrawn, often not stepping out of her room for an entire day.

She didn't have much experience taking care of a younger sister.

Now, looking at Sheng Yu, she didn't know whether to be strict or gentle with her.

After all, this was a younger sister—different from Ling Dang, who was a generation below.

So in the end, Xu Qingzhu decided to follow her heart and interact naturally.

Sheng Yu wrapped her arms around her neck and leaned close to whisper in her ear, "Sister, that Sister Liang is bad. Can we not be friends with her anymore?"

Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu looked toward Liang Shi and saw her holding a cup of water, looking helpless.

Xu Qingzhu asked Sheng Yu what had happened. After understanding the whole story, Xu Qingzhu paused and said, "Sheng Yu, have you ever thought..."

Sheng Yu blinked at her, full of hope.

She only heard Xu Qingzhu say, "Maybe that sister was right?"

Xu Qingzhu stroked Sheng Yu's head. "If a little genius like Rainbow, who has a photographic memory, is called an idiot, then what should an ordinary, average little kid like you be called? A dummy?"

Sheng Yu: "..."

She opened her mouth wide, about to burst into tears, but Xu Qingzhu stuffed a piece of apple into her mouth. "No crying allowed."

Sheng Yu went to find her mom, feeling wronged, but Su Yao also agreed with Xu Qingzhu's point and asked her in confusion, "Why do you keep targeting little Zhou Caihong?"

Sheng Yu said, "Because she's annoying!"

"It's because she knows more than you," Su Yao said. "She stole your spotlight, didn't she?"

Sheng Yu: "..."

Poor little Sheng Yu couldn't find any allies and only gained a bunch of "enemies."

She ran to a corner and sulked facing the wall.

Everyone burst into laughter at her antics.

In the end, it was Liang Shi who said she'd take her to play in the hallway that cheered her up again.

Footnotes:

¹ **Auntie (姑姑, gūgu):** In Chinese kinship terms, this specifically refers to one's father's sister. The complexity here arises because Chinese has very specific terms for relatives based on both generation and which side of the family they're from. Rainbow (Zhou Caihong) correctly calls Liang Shi "Sister Liang" because of their social relationship, while Ling Dang (Liang Wenxuan) calls her "auntie" because Liang Shi is actually her aunt by blood relation in the Liang family. Sheng Yu, being five years old, is confused by why two children of the same age would use different titles for the same person.